COMMUNICATIONS APPROACH

Another noteworthy theory in the field of international relations is the communications approach. The term 'communication' has been borrowed from the concept of 'cybernetics', which means 'steering'. Norbert Weiner (1948) developed the concept of cybernetics in his famous work *Cybernetics,* to signify the control of communications in political systems. Cybernetics is "a body of theory and technique for the study of probabilities in different but analogous universes such as certain types of machines, animals, individual human beings, societies and nation-states—and the ways in which message transactions function to control such universes".[28] Communication is treated as the cement that makes organizations. It alone enables a group to think together, to see together and to act together. All social sciences require the understanding of communication.

This approach in international relations was developed by Deutsch[29] in his celebrated work *The Nerves of Government: Model of Political Communication and Control* (1963). In this book, Deutsch applies the concept of the theory of information, communication and control to problems of political and social science borrowing from Weiner's concepts of 'feedback', 'channel capacity', and 'memory'. From these, Deutsch developed his concepts of "consciousness," "will" and "social learning". Since 1960s, the communications approach became popular in social sciences, and terms like 'feedback', 'steering' and 'learning capacity' have become a common usage while analysing political systems.

For Deutsch, communications, in the true sense of the word, are the nerves of government. A government is analogous to steering of a ship and it is a form of administration of communication channels. Control of steering is central to the problem of steering. A government, which can lessen the uncertainty of the international environment, has an advantage and can steer clear in the troubled waters of international relations. For this, the main component is information which is vital to the state's decision-making, both present and future, vis-à-vis other states as well as non-state actors about their present and future courses of actions. Very important in this